

Pudu puda

Southern pudu



Length 34 in (85 cm)

Tail 2 in (5 cm)

Weight Up to 33 lb (15 kg)

Location S.W. South America

Social unit Individual

Status Near threatened



The southern pudu is one of 2 small, stocky species of pudu. It is buff to red-brown with rounded ears. The male's antlers are simple spikes, 3¼ in (8 cm) long. Solitary and diurnal, it dwells in moist forests, hiding in understory thickets, where it feeds on bark, buds, fruit, and flowers—but seldom eats grass. It is sexually mature at 6 months.



Rangifer tarandus

Reindeer



Length 5½–6¾ ft (1.7–2.1 m)

Tail 5½–6¾ in (14–16 cm)

Weight 120–530 lb (55–240 kg)

Location N. North America, Greenland, N. Europe to E. Asia

Social unit Group

Status Vulnerable



Known as caribou in North America, the reindeer has long antlers with a distinctive shovel-like brow tine on one side. It grazes grasses, sedges, and herbs in summer, and mosses, lichens, and fungi in the long winter. One calf is born in May–June after a gestation of 210–240 days.

COLOR VARIATION
American forms have mainly brown coats with darker legs; European and Asian reindeer (shown) are grayer.



MIGRATION



Some reindeer travel 9–40 miles (15–65 km) daily within the same region; others migrate up to 750 miles (1,200 km) twice yearly. In some populations, females and young move to the calving grounds in spring, males following later.

Capreolus capreolus

European roe deer



Length 3¼–4¾ ft (1–1.3 m)

Tail ¼–1¼ in (1–3 cm)

Weight 37–66 lb (17–30 kg)

Location Europe, W. Asia

Social unit Variable

Status Least concern





This deer has a black muzzle band and variable white chin and throat patches. The white rump patch, which can be fluffed out when the deer is alarmed, is heart-shaped in the female, kidney-shaped in the male (shown). The male has rough-surfaced, 3-point antlers. The sleek, bright red-brown summer coat molts to a longer, denser gray coat in winter.

Alces alces

Moose



Length 7¾–9¾ ft (2.4–3 m)

Tail 4¾–6¼ in (12–16 cm)

Weight 615–1,320 lb (280–600 kg)

Location Alaska, Canada, N. Europe to N. and E. Asia

Social unit Variable

Status Least concern



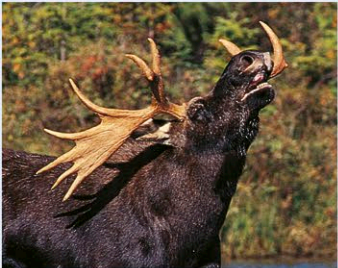
The moose is the largest deer, with males up to twice as heavy as females. Found in woods close to swamps, lakes, and other water, it may submerge in summer to reach roots of lilies and other aquatic plants. The winter diet is mainly twigs of trees such as willow and poplar. Moose live alone or in small family groups.

Males rut in September–October. The 1–2 young are born after 234 days' gestation, and weaned by 4–5 months.

COLORATION
The moose is brownish gray in summer, grayer in winter. Its paler-hued, long legs have wide hooves for wading in mud and walking on soft snow.



MOOSE HEAD



The moose's very broad muzzle and flexible lips help to grasp water plants and to strip leaves from twigs. The male's massive antlers may span 6½ ft (2 m); each has up to 20 points, mostly growing from the palm-shaped "beam."

Pronghorn

PHYLUM	Chordata
CLASS	Mammalia
ORDER	Artiodactyla
FAMILY	Antilocapridae
SPECIES	1

Named after the "prong" on its horns, the pronghorn is the only species in its family. The horns are unusual in that they consist of a horny sheath on a bony core (as in antelopes), but are forked and shed yearly (as are deer's antlers).

SWIFT RUNNERS
The pronghorn is one of the fastest mammals—it can reach speeds of over 40 mph (65 kph). In winter, herds of over 1,000 animals may gather.



Antilocapra americana

Pronghorn



Length 4¼–4¾ ft (1.3–1.4 m)

Tail 3¼–4 in (9.7–10.5 cm)

Weight 65–175 lb (30–80 kg)

Location W. and C. North America

Social unit Variable

Status Least concern



The pronghorn is red-brown to tan, with white underside, face, rump, and neck bands. The male has a black neck patch, and horns that



are longer than the ears, with a forward-facing prong halfway up. The female's horns are shorter than the ears. Herds of over 1,000 form in winter, splitting into smaller groups in summer. Many plants feature in the pronghorn's diet.